

THE OPERATOR'S LOG

ISSUE
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Field notes from a working real-estate operation across Michigan, Ohio, and Indiana.

Welcome to The Operator's Log — a monthly record of what we actually bought, built, and learned across the portfolio. No projections, no hype. Just the work, written down.

We're at **50+ doors** and a **\$12M+ portfolio** across Michigan, Ohio, and Indiana, building toward **200 doors by 2030**. Here's where the last cycle landed.

WHAT WE BOUGHT / WHAT WE'RE BUILDING

Deal spotlight: 17 Lo Presto Avenue · Hillsdale, MI

The flagship. A property two blocks from Hillsdale College that most buyers drove past — and that we took down to the studs.

- **Strategy:** Buy → Rehab → Rent → Refinance → Repeat (BRRRR), run in-house
- **Scope:** Refinished hardwood, full bath remodel in subway tile, new kitchen and laundry, fresh exterior
- **How:** Bought direct from the owner, no agents on either side. Rebuilt by our own crews, tracked weekly on the execution sheet across every trade until it was done.
- **Status:** Fully renovated · stabilized · holding

What we'll keep saying about this one: the finishes get the photos, but the execution sheet earned them. A renovation is an operations problem disguised as a design problem. When every trade is tracked weekly, the project closes instead of drifting — and the door goes back to the community as long-term housing.

MARKET NOTE — MI / OH / IN

Michigan (Hillsdale · Jackson County). The heart of the operation. Single-family and small multifamily, acquired through the BRRRR loop and stabilized for working families, students, and locals. The market has long been served by absentee owners — which is exactly the gap a local operator fills. 2030 target here: 100 homes revitalized in Hillsdale.

Ohio (Cleveland). Furnished mid-term housing near the hospital systems and universities — 30-to-180-day stays for the medical corridor, traveling professionals, and grad students. The mispricing sits between hotel inventory and the 12-month lease. We live in that gap.

Indiana (South Bend). Distressed and overlooked single-family homes others walk past — bad histories, deferred maintenance, sellers who need an exit before foreclosure. We rebuild them to a standard a family wants to live in, then hold long-term. Second-chance housing that holds.

The through-line: these markets are chosen on purpose — large enough to scale, small enough to know personally. They reward operators with infrastructure on the ground and punish anyone

underwriting from a distance.

LESSON FROM THE FIELD

Not all real estate is sexy.

One of last cycle's best outcomes started with a difficult tenant situation and serious deferred maintenance — the kind of file most buyers close and walk away from. We worked through the eviction, ran ozone treatment, cleaned the house down to the studs, and put it back on the market. It's now stabilized with a new long-term family in it.

The takeaway is unglamorous and that's the point: the numbers worked because we showed up and did the work. There's no clever financing that substitutes for willingness to do the hard part. In this business, the unsexy work *is* the moat.

If you operate in the Midwest — or you're a property owner thinking about a direct sale down the road — I read every reply to this email. The full portfolio, the markets, and what our partners say in their own words are at **shavitrootman.com**.

Building communities, profitably.

— Shavit Rootman

The Operator's Log is field notes from a working operation. Nothing here is an offer to sell securities or an investment solicitation. Partnership and equity specifics are discussed privately, one-on-one.